

Continuous Improvement & Non-Conformance (CINC) Procedure

Standards for Registered Training Organisations (RTOs) 2025	Standard 2 – Quality assurance Chapter 6 – Regulatory Compliance and Governance
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Procedure Overview

PURPOSE	The purpose of this procedure is to outline the structured process used by SNS College of Western Australia Pty Ltd to identify, record, prioritise, implement, verify, and close continuous improvement (CI) actions and non-conformances (NCs). This procedure ensures that all findings from validation, industry engagement, transition activities, complaints and appeals, audits, legislative updates, and other quality sources are managed through a single, integrated Continuous Improvement & Non-Conformance (CINC) system in accordance with the Standards for Registered Training Organisations (RTOs) 2025.	
ROLE UNDERTAKING TASK	Role	Responsibility
	CEO	Provides governance oversight; chairs Compliance & Continuous Improvement meetings; approves and monitors high-risk or systemic actions
	Training Manager	Reviews CINC submissions; allocates actions; oversees implementation and verification
	Compliance Manager (if applicable)	Supports regulatory interpretation; verifies closure of non-conformances
	Trainers, Assessors, Staff	Identify and submit CI opportunities and non-conformances; implement assigned actions
Scope	This procedure applies to all SNS College operations, including training and assessment delivery, assessment systems, validation and moderation, learner engagement and support, trainer capability, industry engagement, transition activities, governance, risk, and compliance.	

PROCEDURE

Step	Action	Responsibility	Evidence
Step 1 – Identification and Submission			
Step	Action	Responsibility	Evidence
1.1	Identify opportunities for continuous improvement or non-conformance arising from feedback, validation, audits, transition reviews, industry engagement, complaints, or legislative updates	All staff, trainers, stakeholders	Feedback records; reports; observations
1.2	Submit identified CI or NC via the approved CINC Online Submission Form	Submitter	CINC form submission
1.3	Mandatory submission of findings from validation reports, transition reviews, upheld complaints or appeals, audits, and legislative changes	Training Manager / Compliance Manager	Validation reports; audit reports; transition reviews
Step 2 – Recording and Initial Review			
Step	Action	Responsibility	Evidence
2.1	Record approved submission in the Continuous Improvement Register and assign unique CI reference number	Training Manager	CI Register
2.2	Classify the entry as a Continuous Improvement (CI) opportunity or Non-Conformance (NC), and confirm the source type (e.g. validation, industry engagement, audit, complaint, legislative update) based on the CINC Online Submission Form	Training Manager	CI Register
2.3	Conduct an initial priority and compliance impact assessment using information provided in the CINC Online Submission Form (impact area, urgency, and compliance risk)	Training Manager	Risk rating notes
2.4	Escalate high-risk, urgent, or systemic non-conformances to the CEO for governance oversight	Training Manager	Email / meeting records
2.5	Assign a responsible officer, action requirements, target completion date for corrective and/or preventive actions	Training Manager	CI Register
Where actions are identified during Monthly Operational Meetings or Governance Management Reviews that relate to systemic improvement, compliance obligations, policy amendment, audit findings or risk adjustments, they must be recorded in the Continuous Improvement Register in accordance with this procedure.			
Step 3 – Action Planning and Implementation			
Step	Action	Responsibility	Evidence

Step	Action	Responsibility	Evidence
3.1	Develop and approve corrective or improvement actions	Training Manager / CEO (where required)	Action plan
3.2	Implement approved actions within agreed timeframes	Responsible Officer	Updated documents; training records
3.3	Communicate changes to relevant staff or stakeholders	Training Manager	Emails; meeting minutes
3.4	Upload supporting evidence to CI record	Responsible Officer	Evidence attachments
Step 4 – Evaluation and Verification			
Step	Action	Responsibility	Evidence
4.1	Review completed actions for effectiveness	Training Manager	Review notes
4.2	Verify that the issue has been resolved and no new risks introduced	Compliance Manager / Training Manager	Verification checklist
4.3	Seek additional validation or feedback where required	Training Manager	Follow-up reports
4.4	Recommend closure or further action	Training Manager	CI Register notes
Step 5 – Closure and Governance Review			
Step	Action	Responsibility	Evidence
5.1	Formally close CI or NC in the Continuous Improvement Register	Compliance Manager / Training Manager	CI Register
5.2	Review CI trends, systemic issues and high-risk actions at Quarterly Governance Management Review meetings to determine effectiveness and risk impact	CEO	Meeting minutes

Annex A – Records

Records generated under this procedure include:

- CINC Online Submission Forms
- Continuous Improvement Register
- Validation, audit, transition, and complaint reports
- Meeting minutes and verification evidence

All records are retained in accordance with SNS College record management requirements.

Annex B – Mapping of CINC Online Form to Continuous Improvement System

CINC Form Section / Question	Purpose of Question	How it Informs Continuous Improvement	Related Register / Fields
1. Submitter Name	Identifies source of feedback or issue	Enables follow-up, clarification, and accountability where required	Submitter; Evidence source
2. Source of Information (Industry, Validation, Audit, Complaints, etc.)	Identifies origin of issue or improvement opportunity	Determines mandatory CI triggers and compliance pathways (e.g. validation → Standard 2; complaints → Standard 6)	Impact Area; Risk Rating; CI Source
3. What are you reporting? (CI, NC, Audit finding, etc.)	Classifies issue type	Determines whether item is treated as Continuous Improvement or Non-Conformance	CI / NC Classification
4. Description of Issue / Opportunity	Captures context, impact, and evidence	Supports root cause analysis and informed decision-making	Root Cause Description; Impact Area
5. Priority Level (Minor–Critical)	Assesses urgency and risk	Drives escalation, timeframes, and governance oversight	Priority Level
6. Area Referenced (Training & Assessment, Policies, RPL, etc.)	Identifies affected operational area	Determines which systems, documents, or processes require review	Impact Area; Related Documents
7. Proposed Corrective / Preventive Action	Initial improvement suggestion	Informs corrective and preventive action planning (not approval)	Action Required / Improvement Action

Annex C – Continuous Improvement Register Fields

The Continuous Improvement Register captures and tracks all Continuous Improvement (CI) actions and Non-Conformances (NCs) from identification through to verification and closure. The table below outlines the standard register fields

CINC Response and Register Fields

Field No.	Field Name	Description / Purpose	Example Values
8	Impact Area	Area of RTO operations affected by the issue or improvement opportunity	Training; Assessment; Student Services; Compliance; Governance; Policies & Procedures; Resources / LMS; RPL / Credit Transfer; Validation & Moderation; Certification / Recordkeeping; Marketing & Enrolment; HR / Staffing; WHS; Third Party; Finance; Other
9	Priority Level	Priority assigned based on compliance impact, urgency, and operational risk	Low / Medium / High / Critical
10	Related Document(s) Affected	Documents, systems, or resources requiring review, update, or monitoring	Policy; Procedure; TAS; Assessment Tool; Learning Resource; Mapping Document; Template/Form; Student Handbook; Trainer File; Validation Record; Website / Marketing; LMS Resource; Third Party Agreement; Register / Spreadsheet; Other
11	Action Required / Improvement Action	Action required to address, improve, correct, or monitor the issue	Document update required; Assessment update required; Resource improvement required; Staff training required; Process review required; Validation required
12	Action Owner	Person or role responsible for implementation and follow-up	CEO; Training Manager; Compliance Manager; Trainer/Assessor; Student Services; Administration; Marketing Officer; IT Support; Other
13	Due Date	Approved target completion date for the action	DD/MM/YYYY
14	Status	Current implementation or review status of the CI or NC	Open; In Progress; Pending Verification; Closed; On Hold; Withdrawn
15	Date Completed	Date the action or improvement activity was completed	DD/MM/YYYY
16	Evidence Provided	Evidence demonstrating implementation or completion of the action	Updated policy; Revised TAS; Updated assessment tool; Staff training record; Validation report; Website update
17	Verification Method	Method used to confirm effectiveness or completion	Document Review; Internal Audit; Validation Activity; Sampling; Observation; Peer Review; Governance Review
18	Closure Notes	Summary of final outcome, effectiveness, or additional follow-up requirements	Action completed and verified; Monitoring to continue; No further action required
19	Escalated NC? (Y/N)	Identifies whether the item requires formal non-conformance escalation or systemic review	Yes / No
20	Root Cause Description (only for escalated NCs)	Summary of the underlying cause of the escalated non-conformance	Policy gap; Human error; System failure; Procedure not followed; Communication failure; External change

21	Preventive Action (only for escalated NCs)	Action implemented to prevent recurrence of the escalated issue	Additional staff training; Procedure review; Increased monitoring; Internal audit follow-up; System improvement
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Version Control					
Date	Summary of Modifications	Modified by	Version	Date of Implementation	Next Review Date
26/01/2026	Reconstructed procedure to align with integrated CINC framework and Standards for RTOs 2025	SNS College of Western Australia	2.0	26/01/2026	26/01/2027
25/02/2026	Clarified governance and meeting-triggered CI requirements.	SNS College of Western Australia	V2.1	25/02/2026	25/02/2027
15/05/2026	Simplified Continuous Improvement Register structure and aligned backend CI/NC management fields to support proportional, risk-based continuous improvement and streamlined governance processes.	SNS College of Western Australia	V2.2	15/05/2026	15/05/2027

RTO INFORMATION	
Document Name	SNS - PRO -CINC Procedure V2.1
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